



DEPARTMENT OF LANGUAGES AND PERFORMING ARTS

JUNE 2017 SEMESTER

ENG 111: A to V END OF SEMESTER EXAMINATION

DURATION : 2 HOURS

TOTAL = 50 Marks

INSTRUCTIONS: Answer ALL Questions.

SECTION A: THEORY

(10 Marks)

1. What are the advantages of previewing a text? (2 marks)
2. Differentiate subjective exams from open book exams. (2 marks)
3. Outline the main difference between text marking and text labelling. (2 marks)
4. Explain two factors that limit the ability to be an active. (2 marks)
5. State two reasons why post lecture reading is important. (2 marks)

SECTION B: READING COMPREHENSION

(20 Marks)

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

1. Using the title of this passage, write a goal setting question that would give you reason to read the passage. (1 marks)
2. What faster reading technique would you use to identify the word **Sanctuary**? (1 mark)

The Lottery by Chris Abani

Even though it was a wet, rainy afternoon, I was glad my aunt had taken me to the market with her. Even her religious fanaticism, which sometimes prompted her to proselytize embarrassingly, to complete strangers wasn't enough to deaden my good mood. The rainy season in Nigeria was my favourite even as a 10-year-old. It had something to do with the light. It was crisp, like a new bank note or a thing washed and starched. And then there was the way everything smelled.

I inhaled deeply. The scent was a balanced mix of wet earth and the dry roughness of rope. There was continuity in that smell, as if it were the essence of the land itself. I closed my eyes for a moment. Other scents in the market broke through the smell of wet earth-the throat - burning sharpness of peppers, dried fish, the animal-funk of goats and chickens.

Suddenly, a lone voice screamed one word over and over: "Thief! Thief! Thief!" It was picked up slowly, as if the drizzle that afternoon had dampened the scent of blood. My aunt froze and faced the sound, nose sniffing the air like a lioness sensing prey. A man's voice, tired and breathless, tried to counter the rising chant with a feeble retort: "It's a lie! It's a lie!"

I drew nearer to my aunt, confused and more than a little afraid, but she shook off my clutching hand. Her head turned like an antenna seeking a signal. The sound of a chase grew closer-desperate, pounding feet and shouts. A man with a wild expression came around a corner and nearly knocked over a stall. Young men were almost on his heels, followed some distance behind by a larger cluster. The man ran past us, and it seemed as if I could see the pores in his skin. As he pushed past, my aunt slapped him across the face. He flinched but did not stop; he was headed for the courtyard in the middle of the market, where the retired elders sat daily to judge and dispense justice. I imagined the man bursting into the clearing, cries of "Sanctuary, sanctuary!" breaking from his lips. The council of elders was the highest court in my community, besides, of course, the civil system. It arbitrated on everything from murder to marital disputes, and its authority was never questioned. I felt certain the man would be safe there.

This was the mob justice I had read about in the newspaper editorials that my father made my homework. Rife with condemnations of the mob lynching that were becoming the norm in the 70s, the editorials pointed out that these victims of vigilante justice received no trials and

that the crimes they were accused of were never investigated. The editorials went a step further to suggest that most of those killed this way were probably innocent. But in the terror of that moment, editorials were of little use to the man running for his life and would do little to placate the angry horde. My aunt dragged me along behind the crowd that swept past us.

The man stood in the middle of the clearing facing the elders while the crowd of people pressed around them. In the center of this sacred space, the sole elder who stood up and called for tolerance was booed and pelted with rotten fruit. He sat down quickly and turned his face away. I was sure that the man was about to be lynched. How could the crowd ignore the elder's intervention? And why didn't the other elders speak out.

The mob was oddly silent; its loud breathing filled the space. The accused man began to beg, but people were too busy picking up stones and tree branches, anything that could be used as a weapon. A young man broke through the crowd carrying an old rubber tire and a metal can. He hung the tire from the accused's neck. This singular action ended the man's pleas for mercy. Resigned, he sobbed softly, mumbling inaudibly, but he didn't move as the young man emptied the contents of the can onto him. The young man smiled and talked as he went about his task. 'You see why crime doesn't pay? I am doing this for you, you know, if you burn here, you won't burn in hell. God is reasonable.'

Finishing, he held up a box of matches. The crowd roared. The elder who had tried intervening spoke again, but nobody listened. Someone called out; bring the children forward so that they can learn." My aunt hustled me to the front. Next to me stood a girl. Her face was impassive; I was ashamed at my fear. I never saw the match fall, but I felt the heat as the man erupted into a sheet of flame, burning like a lighthouse in the drizzly haze. "Watch," my aunt said as I tried to turn away from the writhing figure.

As the man burned, people began to file past him in an orderly manner like the offertory line in the Catholic Church I attended. As they walked past, they spat on the incandescent figure. My aunt spat. I looked away, hand held over my nose at the smell of burning flesh, horrified that it reminded me of kebabs. "Spit," she snapped, rapping me on the head with her knuckles. I spat

1. List **three** different types of smells mentioned in the passage. (3 marks)

2. Do you think the man being chased is a thief? Explain your answer. (2 marks)
3. What do you think about the religious nature of the writer's aunt? (2 marks)
4. Why does the man in the passage run towards the courtyard? (2 marks)
5. In this passage the crowd gives in to social pressure to lynch the man. Using your knowledge of this passage and your background knowledge, explain another kind of social pressure that one is likely to succumb to. (2marks)
6. As a Christian, how would you respond to the circumstances described in the passage? (2 marks)
7. Explain the vocabulary technique you would use to get the meaning of the word **proselytize**. (1 marks)
8. Explain the meaning of the following words and phrases as used in the passage. (5 marks)
 - a) feeble retort
 - b) arbitrated
 - c) rife
 - d) impassive
 - e) writhing figure

SECTION C: SUMMARY WRITING

(10 MARKS)

In a paragraph of about 100 words, write a summary describing the events leading to the mob justice.

SECTION D: LITERATURE

(10 MARKS)

Nganga Mbugua: *Different Colours*

Read the excerpt below and answer the questions that follow.

Several months after this encounter, Miguel's and Taidora's steamy but tempestuous affair ended as abruptly as it had started when Taidora's father sent her to study public administration at a university in Missouri, USA.

He believed that with the expanding democratic space in the country, there would be room for women to take up leadership. He wanted to prepare his daughter for the future

1. Describe the encounter referred to in this excerpt. 2 marks
2. With examples explain an aspect of style used in this excerpt. 2 marks
3. What role does Taidora's father play in this novel? 2 marks
4. Demonstrate how women have taken up leadership in this novel 4 marks